

GENERATED FROM LAUNCHROOM SIMULATION DECISIONS.

CareerForge Day 6 Launch Incident Report

Generated from LaunchRoom simulation decisions.

During this LaunchRoom simulation, Nandini Chaurasiya made 9 operational incident decisions, experienced 9 consequence events, and produced a stakeholder-ready incident brief under time pressure.

Completion Status

Completed by timer end

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Decision Timeline

TIME	CATEGORY	PROMPT	DECISION	LATENCY	MODE	REASON
T+01	Traffic control	Checkout issues are rising, but the drop is still converting. Do we pause checkout?	Throttle traffic	75s	chosen	want to reduce further customer harm while still allowing some sales to continue.
T+03	Refund handling	Duplicate charge reports are real. Do we auto-refund suspected duplicates or wait for reconciliation ?	Auto-refund suspected duplicates	54s	chosen	I accepted that some customers would need manual review because protecting financial accuracy was better than issuing incorrect

TIME	CATEGORY	PROMPT	DECISION	LATENCY	MODE	REASON
						refunds. Confirmed duplicate charges were refunded immediately to preserve trust.
T+04	Engineering prioritization	We can only put one engineer on the hot path right now. What do we prioritize?	Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression	61s	chosen	I prioritized webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression because customer payment accuracy was the highest trust risk. I accepted that inventory inconsistencies might persist temporarily because financial harm was more urgent
T+05	Founder escalation	I need a leadership recommendation. Are we protecting revenue or trust first?	Protect customer trust first	39s	chosen	Customers losing money or confidence in the platform creates long-term damage that is harder to recover from than short-term revenue loss.
T+06	Support containment	Support cannot keep up. What do	Publish FAQ with refund/order	42s	chosen	I chose to publish FAQ guidance

TIME	CATEGORY	PROMPT	DECISION	LATENCY	MODE	REASON
		we publish for customers right now?	status guidance			because customers needed immediate clarity about orders and refunds. I accepted that some details might change later because transparent communication was better than silence.
T+07	AI pressure check	AI suggests: rollback checkout immediately and auto-refund all suspected duplicates. Do you trust, modify, or ignore this recommendation?	Modify AI: narrow refunds, isolate affected SKU, keep state checks	63s	chosen	I accepted slower resolution for some customers to avoid large-scale false refunds and unnecessary checkout rollback while the team continued investigating the actual issue.
T+07	Customer communication	Customers are posting screenshots. What do we communicate now?	Publish transparent delay + refund message	44s	chosen	We acknowledged the issue openly, informed customers that some orders may be delayed, and assured them that affected refunds would be

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						handled. This protected long-term customer trust
T+08	Ops uncertainty	Rollback is available, but queued payment events may still land. Do we rollback, hotfix, or isolate the affected SKU?	Hotfix duplicate event handling	57s	chosen	I prioritized a targeted hotfix to stop duplicate event processing while keeping the service running. This reduced customer harm without causing a complete shutdown
T+09	Containment strategy	Final call: what are we containing, what are we not fixing, and what risk are we accepting?	Contain payments/orders, defer analytics	70s	chosen	I prioritized stabilizing payments and order processing while deferring non-critical systems like analytics. I accepted reduced visibility into business metrics in order to protect customers and maintain essential operations

Consequence Summary

TIME	DECISION	CONSEQUENCE	METRIC IMPACT	STAKEHOLDER REACTION
T+01	Throttle traffic	Traffic throttled. System pressure drops without fully stopping the launch.	active users -520, success rate +4, failed payments -18, duplicate charges -6, webhook lag -55, refund requests -5, support tickets +8, founder pressure +6, support pressure -6	Traffic throttle bought us room, but payment inconsistency still needs a containment call.
T+03	Auto-refund suspected duplicates	Auto-refund rule applied. Support pressure drops, but refund volume and finance scrutiny increase.	refund requests +42, support tickets -45, support pressure -18, founder pressure +8, failed payments -12	Auto-refunds reduce support heat, but Finance will need post-incident review for false positives.
T+04	Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression	Engineering focused on duplicate side effects. Payment/order inconsistency improves.	duplicate charges -16, webhook lag -110, success rate +5, failed payments -28, inventory mismatch -5, support pressure -12	Duplicate webhook processing is stabilizing. Queue lag still exists, but repeated side effects are down.
T+05	Protect customer trust first	Customer trust prioritized. Business pressure rises, but public harm and support chaos reduce.	founder pressure +14, support pressure -18, support tickets -45, refund requests +10, duplicate charges -8, failed payments -20	I do not like the revenue hit, but I can stand behind a customer-trust call if the reasoning is clear.
T+06	Publish FAQ with refund/order status guidance	Support gained a consistent script. Some uncertainty remains, but customer handling improves.	support tickets -58, support pressure -22, founder pressure +5, refund requests +8	FAQ is giving agents cover. Customers still want refunds, but responses are consistent now.

TIME	DECISION	CONSEQUENCE	METRIC IMPACT	STAKEHOLDER REACTION
T+07	Modify AI: narrow refunds, isolate affected SKU, keep state checks	AI recommendation modified. Containment improves while avoiding broad irreversible side effects.	refund requests +18, support tickets -36, support pressure -16, founder pressure +6, inventory mismatch -8, duplicate charges -8	Modified AI advice is safer. We get containment without blindly trusting a broad rollback/refund action.
T+07	Publish transparent delay + refund message	Transparent communication reduces support pressure while accepting reputational discomfort.	support tickets -80, support pressure -24, founder pressure +6, refund requests +8	Clear message is helping. Tickets are still high, but customers know what will happen next.
T+08	Hotfix duplicate event handling	Hotfix targeted the likely side-effect path. Some inventory uncertainty remains.	duplicate charges -14, webhook lag -90, failed payments -24, error rate -3, support pressure -8	Hotfix is reducing duplicate side effects. Inventory still needs reconciliation after the incident.
T+09	Contain payments/orders, defer analytics	Payment/order safety prioritized. Revenue impact remains, but customer-money harm is contained.	duplicate charges -18, failed payments -45, support tickets -60, error rate -4, founder pressure +8, support pressure -18	Understood. We will take the revenue hit and explain that payment safety comes first.

Incident Prioritization Matrix

DERIVED PRIORITY	EVIDENCE	WHY IT MATTERED
Critical	Payment success without order confirmation and duplicate charge pressure.	Customer money impact required immediate containment and communication.

DERIVED PRIORITY	EVIDENCE	WHY IT MATTERED
High	Webhook retries, duplicate events, and inventory mismatch appeared together.	Systemic state consistency risk could create repeated side effects.
High	Support tickets and screenshots increased during the incident.	Customer-facing communication affected trust and support load.
Deferred	Analytics/dashboard visibility was not the core customer-money failure.	Cosmetic visibility work should not outrank payment/order containment.

Stakeholder Incident Brief

Current situation

FlashCart experienced checkout instability during a high-traffic limited drop, including payment/order inconsistencies, webhook lag, and support escalation.

Actions taken

Throttle traffic; Auto-refund suspected duplicates; Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression; Protect customer trust first; Publish FAQ with refund/order status guidance; Modify AI: narrow refunds, isolate affected SKU, keep state checks; Publish transparent delay + refund message; Hotfix duplicate event handling; Contain payments/orders, defer analytics

Tradeoffs accepted

Traffic throttled. System pressure drops without fully stopping the launch. Auto-refund rule applied. Support pressure drops, but refund volume and finance scrutiny increase. Engineering focused on duplicate side effects. Payment/order inconsistency improves. Customer trust prioritized. Business pressure rises, but public harm and support chaos reduce. Support gained a consistent script. Some uncertainty remains, but customer handling improves. AI recommendation modified. Containment improves while avoiding broad irreversible side effects. Transparent communication reduces support pressure while accepting reputational discomfort. Hotfix targeted the likely side-effect path. Some inventory uncertainty remains. Payment/order safety prioritized. Revenue impact remains, but customer-money harm is contained.

Remaining risk

Some customer reconciliation and post-incident engineering follow-up may remain depending on decisions made during the simulation.

Performance Signals

Strong signals observed

- Early containment decision was made before the crisis fully escalated.

- Customer communication was addressed before the end of the incident.
- At least one decision included substantial tradeoff reasoning.
- Decision latency stayed controlled under pressure.

Risk signals observed

None observed.

Leadership Signals

Leadership strengths

- Owned difficult tradeoffs instead of only preserving launch momentum.
- Prioritized engineering containment over cosmetic visibility work.
- Maintained decision pace under timer pressure.
- Communicated clearly under uncertainty.

Leadership risks

None observed.

Portfolio Summary

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